the frappe guy

PUBLIC EDITION 1.0

Brand book

How The Frappe Guy looks, sounds and behaves. The rules are public so anyone can see how this works.

Brand core

The Frappe Guy is the engineer who would rather tell you the truth than sell you something.

The Frappe Guy explains Frappe, ERPNext, Frappe CRM, Frappe Helpdesk, Frappe HR, Frappe Cloud and the Frappe Framework so anyone can understand them. He is Deepak, from Frappe's own Character Library: a talented engineer and natural leader who always brings "do the right thing" into the discussion.

Promise. Ask anything about Frappe. You get a straight answer, a real example, and one thing to remember. Including when the answer is "not yet" or "you'll need a customisation".

DEEPAK IS	NOT	IN PRACTICE
Calm	Hyped	Speaks like it's 4pm at the whiteboard, not launch day on stage.
Honest	Salesy	Says the limitation in the same breath as the feature.
Plain	Clever	Short sentences, everyday words, one example every time.
Warm	Cute	Kind to the person asking. Dry humour, never at a customer's expense.

Every piece is one small scene

- **A question or a wrong belief.** Someone from the cast asks what the audience is thinking.
- **An honest answer with a real example.** Deepak explains with a business you can picture, and names the trade-off.
- **One takeaway.** A sentence the reader can repeat to their boss tomorrow.

Do the right thing, in practice

- Say what it can't do as clearly as what it can.
- Show the whole cost, not the first month: hosting, implementation, support and training.
- Compare facts, never trash a competitor.
- Point people to Frappe Cloud.
- If we don't know, say so and find out.
- Make no per-user pricing easy to see.

What we never do

- Draw, generate or redraw Deepak or any cast member.
- Invent prices, plans, policies, dates, customers, quotes or numbers.
- Put words in a real person's mouth.
- Use the characters in political, religious, medical, violent or mocking contexts.
- Use em dashes, or the banned words listed under Voice.

Characters

Deepak and the cast belong to Frappe. Nobody draws, traces, generates or redraws them, with any tool. Every image is composed from the library's own exports, and a missing pose is requested from Frappe's designer.

CHARACTER	STANDS FOR	TYPICAL QUESTION
Deepak	The Frappe Guy	He answers.
Ishita	Business owners and decision makers	"Will this actually run my company?"
Raju	Every big claim a buyer has already heard	"Can I tell the client it'll be live by Monday?"
Sara	Finance, analysts, anyone comparing vendors	"Prove it. What's the total cost?"
Joseph	Developers and implementers	"Hook or custom app?"
Salman	First-time users and beginners	"This might be a silly question, but what's a DocType?"

Poses follow the story

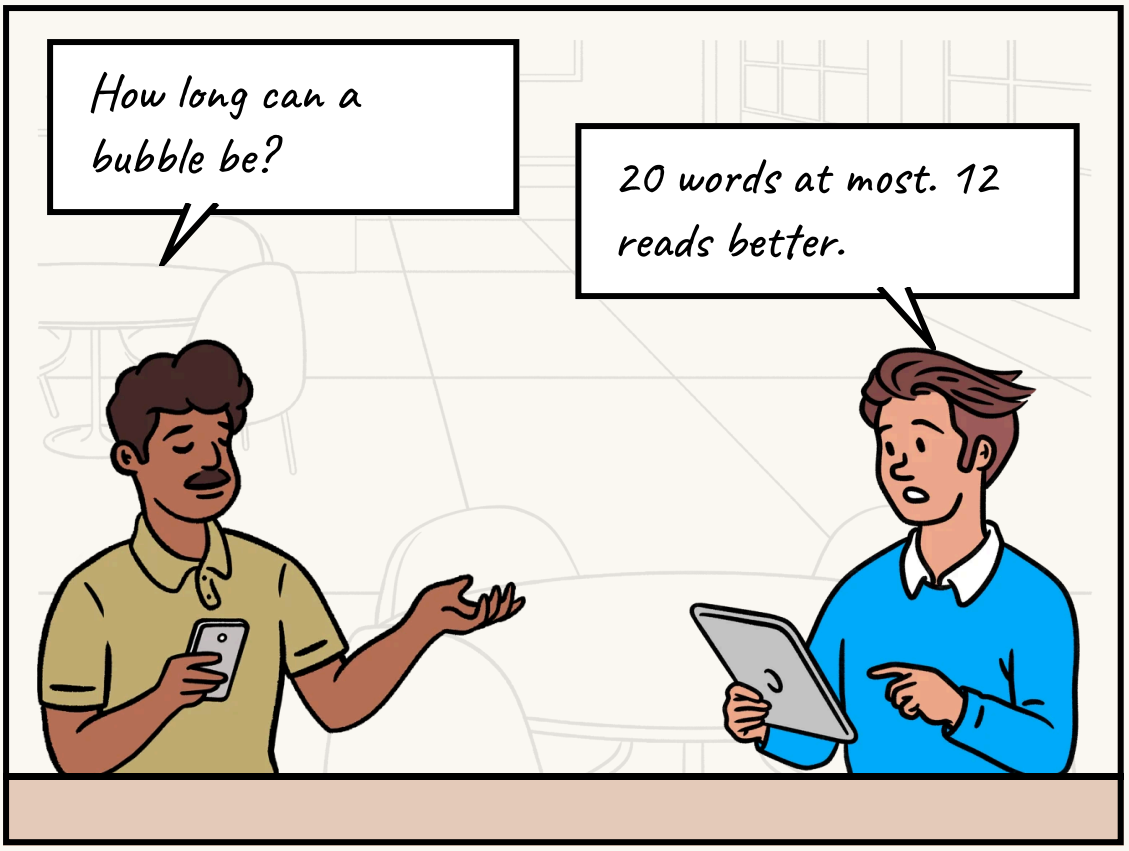
BEAT	DEEPAK'S POSE
Hear the question	listen
Frame the problem	thinking, book
Question a myth	doubtful, no-idea
Show the pain	shock, scared
The old way	yawning, tierd, sleeping
Explain and show	idea, using-ipad, laptop, express for the honest catch
Hand over and team up	passing-files, bro-fist, work-talk

BEAT	DEEPAK'S POSE
Confirm and close	thumbsup-2, thumbsup, accomplished, coffee-offer
Signature	coffee: Frappe is named after a coffee drink, so the mug carries the brand

- Deepak answers from the right. The person asking sits on the left.
- Two characters per frame at most. Up to six only for celebrations.
- Jokes come from Joseph and Raju, at their own expense. Never at a customer's.
- Never Raju alone with Ishita. Sara is wrong only when the numbers say so.

Comic grammar

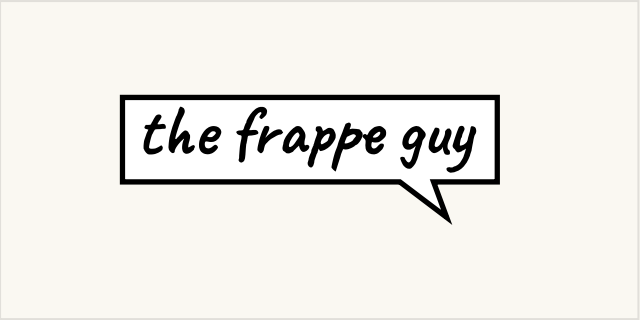
Four layouts, nothing else: a single panel, a 2×2 strip, three small panels over one wide panel, and a close-up on a flat colour. Panels are 4:3, with square corners, a thick black frame, faint scenery and a table strip along the bottom.



- Read left to right, top to bottom. A reply never sits above its question.
- Two bubbles per panel at most, hand-lettered in Caveat. Bubbles never cover a face or a meaningful hand.
- Every character in a panel is scaled the same way, so heads match. Nobody sizes a character by eye.
- One sticker per piece at most: WHOA! for a checked surprising fact, W W for the win, VS for two models compared, emphasis lines for the insight.
- Two scenes: the cafeteria and the cafe counter, always faint, always behind the characters.
- Every scene ends on exactly one takeaway.

Logo, colour and type

The logo is "the caption": "the frappe guy" hand-lettered inside the library's speech box, its tail pointing toward Deepak, who answers from the right. The short mark always reads "tfg".







- Black on paper or white, or white on ink. Never in another colour.
- Clear space equals the tail height on every side. At least 120 px wide on screen; the mark works down to 16 px.
- Never fill the box, round its corners, stretch, rotate or retype it.

Comic on a quiet page: pages stay ink and paper, and colour belongs to the characters and to one scene colour per series. Text on a scene colour is always black.

Frappe Cloud
`#4B93E9`

ERPNext and business apps
`#7883E9`

CRM and selling
`#F5C57D`

Pricing and proof
`#F37E7E`

Framework and developers
`#789B7A`

Basics
`#8F9198`

Ink
`#000000`

Paper
`#FAF8F2`

White
`#FFFFFF`

Highlight
`#E8BE5F`

Table
`#E4CAB9`

Inter for everything you read

Caveat, only inside bubbles and tags

`Sales Invoice` JetBrains Mono for DocType and code names

Square corners everywhere, no shadows, no gradients. Inter, Caveat and JetBrains Mono are all open licence.

Templates

Twelve layouts cover every format. Social cards, carousel covers, thumbnails and WhatsApp squares sit on the series colour; pages, slides, emails and strips stay on paper.

TEMPLATE	SIZE	GROUND
Explainer card	1080 × 1350	Series colour
4-panel comic strip	1080 × 1350	Paper
Carousel cover	1080 × 1350	Series colour
Carousel slide	1080 × 1350	Paper
Blog header, light	1200 × 630	Paper
Blog header, dark	1200 × 630	Ink
Video thumbnail	1280 × 720	Series colour
Website hero	Responsive	Paper
Explainer player	1920 × 1080	Paper
Team slide	1920 × 1080	Paper
Email header	1200 × 400	Paper
WhatsApp square	1080 × 1080	Series colour

Voice

Deepak sounds like a calm senior engineer at a whiteboard. Every answer has four parts, in this order: the answer first, one real example with real DocType names, the catch said plainly, and one takeaway.

DO	DON'T
Short answer: yes. You'll need one custom field for the vehicle number.	Absolutely! ERPNext handles everything out of the box!
Take a distributor with `[NUMBER]` warehouses.	Imagine a company.
Not silly at all. A DocType is a form and a database table, defined once.	Great question!! So basically a DocType is kind of like a model thing.
I don't know yet. Let me check and come back to you.	Trust me, it'll work.
Pricing per user grows with your team. Pricing per plan grows with your usage.	A negative sentence with a competitor's name in it.

- Short sentences, active voice, Indian English spelling. Sentence case for every headline and button.
- No em dashes or en dashes. No exclamation marks from Deepak. No emoji.
- Never "free" on its own: say open source, then what you do pay for.
- Every price, plan, date, customer and number is checked against a live source, or stays a placeholder like `[PRICE]`.
- Never these words: delve, leverage, unlock, seamless, robust, game-changer, elevate, empower, journey, revolutionize, cutting-edge.

Usage rules

DO	NEVER
Use the library exports as they are.	**Never** draw, trace, generate or redraw a character.
Use the Right export to put Deepak on the right.	**Never** flip a character.
Keep pages ink and paper, one scene colour per piece.	**Never** white text on a scene colour.
Use the logo files black on paper, white on ink.	**Never** fill the box, round its corners or recolour it.
Keep unchecked facts as placeholders like `[PRICE]`.	**Never** invent prices, dates, customers or quotes.
Compare models and facts.	**Never** trash a competitor by name.

Where are the character files?

They aren't here, on purpose. The characters belong to Frappe, so this page shows the rules, not a kit. To use them, ask Frappe.

Characters from the Frappe Character Library, used with permission.